

This guide lets you run the job yourself, without handing it to an architect. Work through it in order and tick every box. Rev B layout: stair → K1 (new glazed exterior door) → landing → V door on the right → mudroom; the old east (stair-side) doorway is walled up. For technical detail see the main file (A3 pack); page numbers point there.

1 Measure first — 6 measurements (tape measure + phone camera is enough)

- ☐ **Bay width and length:** wall to wall, measured at both ends (walls can be out of true). Target $\approx 2.0 \times 4.0$ m (landing + partition + mudroom).
- ☐ **Ceiling height:** from the bay floor to the underside of the roof timbers. 3.20 m or more is comfortable (the floor rises 0.90 m and ≥ 2.30 m of room must remain).
- ☐ **Landing depth (north-south):** from the house door to the stair head. The 1.40 m on plan is an ASSUMPTION — the K1 door and the light partition are finalised from this measurement.
- ☐ **Openings to be closed:** old east (stair-side) doorway + window/vent — position, width, height, sill level, photo.
- ☐ **Rainwater:** where does the gutter discharge? If it runs to the foot of the new wall, note it (it will be re-routed).
- ☐ **Services in the bay:** camera, cables, light — photograph them all (they will be relocated).

2 One e-mail to the town hall — 10 minutes, free

Send the e-mail below to the planning desk of Orange town hall (Service Urbanisme, Mairie d'Orange). The reply pins down which rules apply to you. Keep the reply — it is the first document in your file.

E-MAIL TEMPLATE (IN FRENCH — COPY IT)

« Bonjour, je suis propriétaire de la parcelle située [adres]. Je projette de fermer un porche couvert existant (≈ 8 m²) pour créer une entrée, avec une nouvelle porte vitrée en haut de l'escalier. Pourriez-vous me confirmer : 1) la zone PLU de la parcelle, 2) si elle se situe dans le périmètre des abords des Monuments Historiques (avis ABF), 3) les règles de teinte d'enduit et de menuiserie applicables ? Merci. »

- ☐ **Sent:** e-mail date:
- ☐ **Reply received:** PLU zone: · within the Monuments Historiques perimeter? YES / NO · render colour rule:

WHY IT MATTERS

Orange has wide heritage-protection zones because of its Roman theatre. If your plot is inside one, the permit takes 1 month longer and the render colour and the look of the K1 door will be dictated — it costs no money, only patience.

3 Permit → waiting → construction: the right order (one page)

Golden rule: paper first, trowel second. Do not break the order below; tick each phase when it is done.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ SEPTEMBER | Measure + file
The 6 measurements from page 1 + photos. Prepare the permit file (Déclaration Préalable — prior-notice permit, form Cerfa 13703): location plan, site plan, section, before/after elevation, photomontage. K1 (new glazed exterior door at the stair head) changes the façade — it MUST appear on the DP sheets; if the file was already lodged, submit an amendment. |
| ☐ OCTOBER | Lodge the file, hang the board
Via the town hall's online counter or in person, 2–4 copies. The same day, fix the yellow site notice (panneau d'affichage) to the gate and photograph it — the objection period runs from this display. |
| ☐ OCT-NOV | Wait (review)
Standard 1 month, 2 months in a protected zone. No reply means approval (silence = consent). Meanwhile collect material prices and ask for furniture quotes — but do NOT order. |
| ☐ NOV-DEC | Wait (objection period)
After approval the neighbours have 2 months to object. Safest is to sit this out too. Meanwhile: get two builder quotes; choose K1 (glazed aluminium exterior door), V (timber interior door) and the floor tile. |
| ☐ DEC-JAN | Shell works (3–4 weeks)
Footing → walls + walling-up of the old east doorway → floor raise → roof junction → window infill → hanging the K1 exterior door → electrical conduits. The sequence is 14 steps in the main file (p.08). |
| ☐ JANUARY | MEASUREMENT DAY
The room is done: final survey with a laser measure. The furniture cutting list is finalised from this survey and the order is placed ONLY NOW . |
| ☐ FEBRUARY | Fit-out + furniture
Insulation, plasterboard, the landing-mudroom light partition (metal studs + double plasterboard) + V door, plaster, tiles, paint; furniture fabrication runs in parallel. When it arrives: installation + LED hook-up. |
| ☐ MARCH | Close-out
Completion declaration (DAACT) to the town hall. Tell your insurer “8 m² added”. The development tax (taxe d'aménagement, ≈ €360–540) arrives next year — not a surprise. |

THE MOST EXPENSIVE MISTAKE

Ordering furniture early, from plan dimensions. A wall shifts 2 cm and the wardrobe will not fit. Order date = the day after MEASUREMENT DAY.

4 Materials shopping list — with the French merchant names

The word to say at the counter is in brackets — just show the list. Quantities are the Rev B take-off (tools/quantities.py; 10% waste included on blocks and mortar). Re-run the take-off after MEASUREMENT DAY.

FOUNDATION AND WALLS

- ☐ Concrete blocks 20 cm (parpaing de 20) — ≈ 330 pcs (≈ 29.6 m² of wall; incl. the old east door infill)
- ☐ Mortar (mortier bâtard) — ≈ 28 bags of 25 kg
- ☐ Ready-mix or cement+sand+gravel (béton C25/30) — ≈ 1.48 m³ (footing 0.85 + ring beam 0.27 + topping 0.36)
- ☐ Rebar 10 mm (fer à béton HA10) — ≈ 29 kg; mesh (treillis ST25) ≈ 9.2 m²
- ☐ Damp-proof course roll (arase étanche / bande d'arase)
- ☐ Wall starter ties (équerre de liaison + scellement chimique)

FLOOR RAISE

- ☐ Precast joists (poutrelle) — ≈ 8 pcs, 2.0 m long, the store cuts them
- ☐ Infill blocks (hourdis / entrevous) — ≈ 8.0 m², to joist spacing
- ☐ Topping concrete is included in the concrete item above
- ☐ Ventilation grilles (grille d'aération) — 2 pcs

PARTITION AND DOORS (REV B)

- ☐ Partition plasterboard (plaque de plâtre BA13) — ≈ 13.0 m² (2 faces $\times$ 2 layers)
- ☐ Partition profiles (rail R48 + montant M48) — ≈ 16.5 m
- ☐ Mineral wool 45 mm, acoustic (laine minérale) — ≈ 5.0 m²
- ☐ K1 exterior door 900 $\times$ 2100 — glazed, thermal-break aluminium (porte d'entrée alu vitrée à rupture de pont thermique), $U_w \leq 1.6$, RC2 lock, self-closing hinges — 1 pc
- ☐ V interior door 830 $\times$ 2100 — timber door set (bloc-porte bois), $U_d \leq 1.4$ — 1 pc

INSULATION AND LININGS

- ☐ Wall insulation 100 mm (isolant $R \geq 3.0$, e.g. laine de verre GR32) — ≈ 21.1 m²
- ☐ Floor insulation PU 80–100 mm (panneau polyuréthane) — ≈ 8.0 m²
- ☐ Vapour barrier (pare-vapeur) + tape
- ☐ Plasterboard 13 mm wall lining (BA13) — ≈ 29.1 m² + profiles (rails/montants)
- ☐ Ceiling insulation 60–100 mm — ≈ 8.0 m² + plasterboard

FINISHES

- ☐ External render (enduit monocouche, e.g. Weberpral M) — ≈ 22.7 m² (≈ 23 bags); colour: match the façade, take a sample
- ☐ Render starter profile (profilé de départ)
- ☐ Anti-slip R10 tiles (carrelage R10) — ≈ 8.8 m² + adhesive + grout
- ☐ Primer + interior paint (sous-couche + peinture mate)

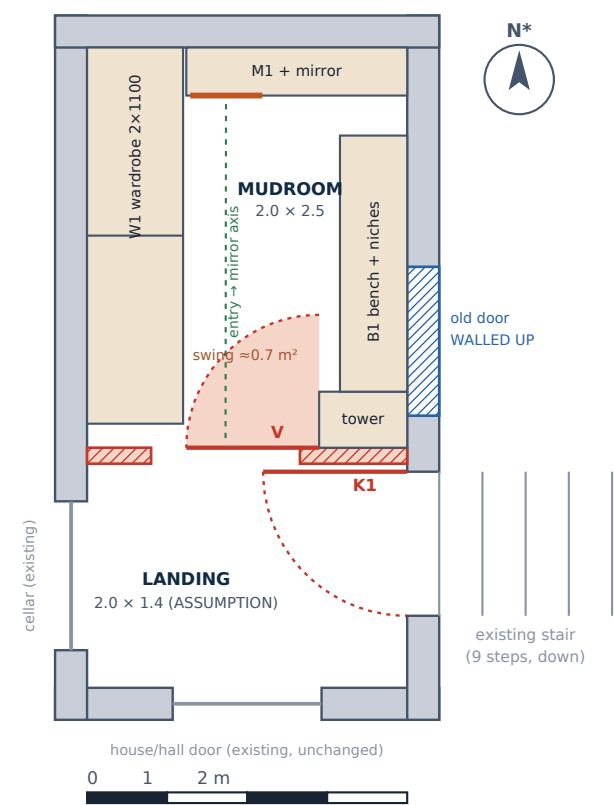
5 Tool list — do not buy, hire

Every French builders' merchant has a daily hire desk (location de matériel). Hire these:

- ☐ Laser level (niveau laser) — for the footing, the floor and furniture day
- ☐ Plate compactor (plaque vibrante) — only if Option B fill is chosen
- ☐ Masonry saw (scie de chantier or Ø230 angle grinder)
- ☐ Mixer (malaxeur) + a wheelbarrow for the pours
- ☐ SDS hammer drill (perforateur SDS) — anchor holes
- ☐ Plasterboard screw bit + board clamp — for the partition (buy, cheap)

6 New circulation — a two-door entrance (Rev B)

Coming up the stair, K1 (new glazed exterior door) opens INTO the landing; on the left is the house door (unchanged), on the right the V door opens INTO the mudroom — whoever enters sees the mirror straight ahead. The diagram uses nominal dimensions.



Schematic plan — dimensions in mm, nominal. Site measurement before fabrication is mandatory.

Why do the doors swing this way?

- K1: a door opening OUT over the stair pushes the opener into the void and the leaf hits anyone coming up — a fall risk. So it opens INTO the landing; hinge on the north jamb, the open leaf rests against the north wall; self-closing hinges stop wind-slam.
- V: because the landing is shallow (1.40 m) it opens INTO the mudroom; hinge on the EAST jamb — the leaf opens a full 90° and parks on the east side, keeping the entry → mirror axis and the wardrobe clear (Phase 4.1).
- Even with both doors open at once the leaves stay in different volumes — no clash scenario.

DEAD ZONE — A DELIBERATE TRADE-OFF

The V leaf’s swing (hatched quarter-circle, $\approx 0.7 \text{ m}^2$) overlaps the use strip in front of W1’s south module: with V open, that module’s door cannot open, and the leaf rests on W1’s south corner before reaching a full 90° (the diagram shows 90°). Because the leaf will not fit in the shallow landing (1.40 m), this overlap was accepted deliberately; in daily use, door closed, there is no issue. The door axis is verified on site on MEASUREMENT DAY.

7 What fits? — capacity table (WP2)

Item	Capacity	Where
Long coats	8 pcs	W1 module A — full-height rail ≈ 1800
Jackets / short hang	12 pcs	W1 module B — double rail $\approx 950 / \approx 1850$
Hooks (bags, scarves, keys)	6 pcs	B1 bench back panel, 1700-1750 band
Daily shoes	6 pairs	B1 bench drawers (2 drawers)
Shoes — tower	10 pairs	Tower 550x350x2350 — mudroom face of the partition, east end
Shoes — seasonal	12 pairs	Top boxes / bridge (above +2000)
Open shelving	3.2 m	M1 corner shelf 5 rows x 0.35 m + niche over the bench 3 x 0.50 m
Closed storage	4.5 m ³	W1 + M1 tower/bridge + bench + shoe tower combined

Source: data/quantities.json → capacity_check (tools/quantities.py Rev B). Count your winter wardrobe against this table — if you exceed it, plan a seasonal rotation.

8 10 Golden Rules

- 1 Do not touch a wall before permit approval + the 2-month objection period have passed.
- 2 K1 never opens OUT over the stair — it opens INTO the landing; self-closing hinges are mandatory.
- 3 Keep at least 90 cm of clear flat area in front of the closed door.
- 4 Raise the floor with the ventilated system (Option A) and do not forget the 2 vents.
- 5 Put a damp-proof course under every new wall — that is the cure for mould.
- 6 Do not mortar the new wall to the roof timbers; compressed wool + mastic in the joint.
- 7 Landing and mudroom tiles at the SAME level (+1.25) — no threshold at the V door; the only threshold is at K1 (max 20 mm).
- 8 Run the electrics before walls and partition close: 2 sockets, sensor light, a 24 V feed for the furniture.
- 9 Do not order the furniture before the room is finished; measurement day + 1.
- 10 Photograph every stage — an archive for the town hall, the insurer and the joiner.

9 Who to call, and when

Who	When	What for
Town-hall planning desk (Service Urbanisme)	At the very start + when lodging	PLU zone, ABF status, permit file submission (incl. K1)
ABF advice (via the town hall)	Only if in a protected zone	Preview of render tone / K1 door look — avoids a refusal
Two local builders (maçon)	While waiting for the permit	Comparative quotes — a price reference even if you self-build
Door supplier (menuiserie alu)	After permit approval	K1 glazed aluminium door + V interior door — 4-6 week lead
Electrician (électricien)	At shell-works step 10	Sockets + light + 24 V feed; NF C 15-100 compliance
Joiner / furniture maker	After MEASUREMENT DAY	Cutting-list revision + order
Freight forwarder (if the TR route)	Together with the order	DAP delivery, A.TR certificate, insurance; VAT reminder
Your insurer	When the work is done	Notify “8 m² of living area added”

WHEN IT IS DONE

DAACT (completion declaration) to the town hall + tell the insurer + keep the invoices in one folder. Then hang the coat, drop the boots in the drawer, lock the door — that is the whole project.